

HOUSE No. 680

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Estela A. Reyes

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to mental health counselors in schools.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Estela A. Reyes</i>	<i>4th Essex</i>	<i>1/15/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 680

By Representative Reyes of Lawrence, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 680) of Estela A. Reyes relative to mental health counselors in public schools. Education.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to mental health counselors in schools.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 71 of the General Laws, as amended by section 219 of chapter 238 of the acts of
2 2024, is here by further amended by adding the following section:

3 Section 102. (a) For the purpose of this section, the following terms shall, unless the
4 context clearly requires otherwise, have the following meanings:

5 “School mental health counselor”, a person licensed or eligible for licensure as a mental
6 health counselor under section 165 of chapter 112.

7 “School psychologist”, a person licensed or eligible for licensure as a licensed
8 educational psychologist under section 165 of chapter 112 who has been certified as a school
9 psychologist by the department of education.

10 (b) Subject to appropriation, each public school shall employ school mental health
11 counselors or school psychologist that have been granted by the commissioner a provisional or
12 standard certificate of employment, pursuant to section 38G, for grades 3 to 12. During the

13 school year, a school mental health counselor or school psychologist shall have at least 1 meeting
14 with each student to ensure that the student: (i) is aware the counselor or psychologist is
15 available to them; (ii) becomes familiar with the counselor or psychologist; and (iii) understands
16 that the counselor or psychologist is accessible to them for whenever they may need.